

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior fintech PM with a track record of shipping regulated products at speed.*

Positioning, ten years of shipping payment, platform, and regulated-data products, now focused on the infrastructure layer that makes digital transactions scale.

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§ WHY TALABAT

talabat processes hundreds of thousands of orders daily across nine countries, which means the payments layer is not a backoffice concern, it is the heartbeat of the business. The job description is specific about what needs to happen: intelligent routing, APM integrations, PCI-DSS compliance, and fraud prevention sitting alongside authorization rate optimisation. That combination of technical depth and regulatory rigour is exactly what I have been doing, not as a separate workstream but as the core of the product. The part of the posting that stands out most is the framing of payments as "a scalable engine that supports all product lines", a platform mindset, not a feature mindset. *That is the frame I bring to day one.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not owned a consumer food-delivery product before; talabat's MENA context, multi-currency, multi-country, cash-heavy last-mile, adds local nuance I would absorb quickly. What I do bring is the underlying mechanic: shipping payment infrastructure in regulated, cross-functional environments where authorization rates and fraud controls are trade-offs that must be measured, not guessed.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, daily coding assistance
- **Lovable**, rapid clickable prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes
- **GPT**, edge-case generation and discovery synthesis
- **n8n**, multi-agent workflow orchestration
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks from raw notes
- **Cursor / VSCode**, lightweight code exploration

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kafka, Python, Kotlin, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Shopware, WhatsApp and Telegram messaging APIs, LLM agents; forecourt and POS payment systems (Scheidt & Bachmann); CGM/KIS clinical interfaces; payment integration product design including P2P flows, consumer checkout UX, and PSP edge-case handling.

§ SIDE PROJECT

QCRYPT AG [YOUTUBE.COM/WATCH?V=NT06F71LGFE](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NT06F71LGFE) →

Quantum-resistant encryption product co-founded and taken to market.

- Built OTP/true-RNG data-encryption architecture as co-founder and Product Owner.
- Owned backup, restore, checkpoint, and key-management product design end to end.
- Served as deputy IT security officer, covering attack-vector mitigation and security governance.
- Directly relevant to talabat's PCI-DSS and fraud-prevention requirements.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT TALABAT

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the payment operations dashboard, trace one failed transaction end to end through routing and gateway logs, and map the current APM coverage against the countries talabat operates in to find the gaps that hurt authorisation rates most.

WEEK 2

Slice, instrument, prioritise.

Identify the single routing or gateway change with the highest expected authorisation-rate lift, write a falsifiable success metric for it, and get it sized with engineering before the sprint review.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Roll the first change to a limited cohort, measure authorisation delta and fraud signal together, and use that data to anchor the roadmap conversation with stakeholders across commercial and compliance.

I COVER LETTER

Dear talabat hiring team,

Payments infrastructure is where I have spent the sharpest part of my product career, from forecourt POS and payment system integration at Scheidt & Bachmann, to P2P consumer payment flows and PSP design, to co-founding Qcrypt where I owned encryption architecture and served as deputy IT security officer. When I read talabat's job description, intelligent routing, APM integrations, fraud prevention alongside authorisation rate optimisation, PCI-DSS compliance, I recognise the exact set of trade-offs I have been navigating professionally.

What draws me specifically to talabat is the scale and the regional complexity. Operating across nine MENA countries, each with its own payment culture, currency, and regulatory baseline, means the infrastructure layer has to be engineered for variance, not built once and assumed to transfer. At Rohde & Schwarz I faced an analogous challenge: a defence AI platform whose data formats, security requirements, and stakeholder expectations differed sharply by country and customer segment. I steered the product from a UI-heavy tool toward a dev-code-friendly integration standard, which cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes and made the system hotfix-capable without a release freeze. That instinct, finding the abstraction layer that handles local variation gracefully, is exactly what a multi-country payments engine needs.

At Scheidt & Bachmann I worked within SAFe across POS, payment, and forecourt systems, navigating the kind of cross-functional, compliance-heavy environment talabat's payments team

operates in. At Bundesdruckerei I owned the national health data platform for the RKI, identity management, highest privacy standards, audit governance, so working where compliance is not optional is familiar terrain, not a constraint I would need to learn from scratch.

My working mode is AI-first. A disputed checkout flow becomes a testable prototype before the next standup. I write the spec, own the acceptance criteria, and instrument success before we build. I do not confuse output with outcome, and I do not let a roadmap become a commitment to the wrong thing, discovery and cheap experiments stay live throughout the lifecycle, not just at the start.

I am open to relocation to Dubai or Abu Dhabi, and I can be available on four weeks' notice. I would be glad to walk through specific payment scenarios, routing logic, APM edge cases, fraud signal design, in a technical conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Philipp Hilbert is a senior product manager with ten-plus years of shipping regulated, cross-functional products across fintech, defence, public sector, and health data. His strongest surface is payment and platform infrastructure: designing the systems that handle transactions, compliance, and integration at scale, and doing so with continuous discovery and AI-first execution. He moves from ambiguity to falsifiable bets quickly, and he brings engineering and design into discovery from day one.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Payment and integration platforms. Payment flow and PSP integration product design, P2P consumer UX, POS and forecourt systems, APM and gateway edge-case handling, PCI-DSS-adjacent security architecture.

Regulated environments. Defence, public sector, health data and insurance: identity management, highest privacy requirements, audit and governance cycles, KYC/KYB and fraud-prevention framing.

Product craft. Continuous discovery, prototype-led validation, outcome negotiation with stakeholders, backlog and release ownership, SAFe at scale (PI planning, release trains), metric definition before build.

Data and AI platforms. Multimodal AI training data pipelines, ETL orchestration and migration, analytics platforms for public use. Kafka, Python, Kotlin, Dagster, dbt, LLM agents.

Cloud, delivery and operations. Bare-metal to container migration, rollout and hotfix pipelines, GitOps. Kubernetes, OpenShift, Red Hat, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

AI-first building. Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Lovable for full prototyping, agent frameworks under own guardrails.

Working tools: Jira, Confluence.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM (FCAS),
B2B SAAS 2024 TO 2025

Steered a multimodal AI data platform from UI-heavy to dev-code-friendly; cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes and made the system fully hotfix-capable. Kafka, Kotlin, Python.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC ANALYTICS
PLATFORM 2023 TO 2024

Public labour-market data made searchable, filterable, and social-media-ready; bare-metal-to-container migration and big ETL migration. Dagster, dbt.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURTECH LOW-CODE SAAS 2022

Launched Claims Center; split an unwieldy 17-person team into three nimble squads with dedicated leads, each owning a clear outcome.

CLINET · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH-TECH MOBILE APP 2021 TO 2022

Native iOS/Android app; integrated the CGM/KIS clinical interface directly.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER · NATIONAL HEALTH DATA
PLATFORM (RKI) 2021

RKI projects DIM and DESH: vaccination statistics and viral-mutation tracking under identity management and highest privacy requirements.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · FUEL-RETAIL INTEGRATION
2020 TO 2021

POS, payment, and forecourt systems; SAFe PI planning and release trains across a complex hardware-software stack.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · PROCUREMENT PLATFORM 2019
TO 2020

Full migration of a legacy webshop to a modern Shopware application for approximately 20,000 users.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · IT MODERNISATION, WIND ENERGY 2019

Full-site modernisation: end devices, servers, switches, lines, and software.

CONSTRUCT8 · PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION MARKETPLACE, B2B
SAAS 2025 TO NOW

Zero-to-one; AI-assisted operations via WhatsApp/Telegram APIs and LLM agents.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

Kvitt (mobile payments, acquired by Sparkasse) · Qcrypt (quantum-resistant encryption, co-founder and Product Owner, deputy IT security officer) · Smart Soil Technologies (nanotech)

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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